

DAVID E. O'NEAL

GRC Engineering | AI Security & Governance | Security Operations
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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 8+ years across security operations, vulnerability management, and security program delivery in financial services, government, aerospace, and industrial environments. Proven track record reducing security risk, accelerating remediation timelines, and building repeatable security processes through automation.

At Bank OZK, investigated phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents daily while tuning phishing detection rules across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco SEG, cutting phishing false positives by 40% and giving the team cleaner signal on real threats.

At Legato Security, led vulnerability and patch management for enterprise clients, cutting critical remediation timelines from several weeks to under 72 hours. Built a Patching-as-a-Service delivery model that reduced manual coordination effort, and now manages project delivery across 10+ enterprise accounts as Project Manager at an MSSP.

Founder of OracleRecon, an independent GRC and AI security consultancy focused on automating risk assessments, compliance workflows, and security program development for small and midsize businesses. Targeting GRC Engineering and AI security roles. M.S. in Cybersecurity from Maryville University.

Certifications: GRC Foundations in Cybersecurity (2024); Practical Security Analyst Assessment (PSAA) — In Progress; Introduction to Hacking Methodology (2026); Level 1 Cyber Threat Hunting Training (2024); SOAR Analyst — Google Cloud Siemplify (2024); XM Cyber Exposure Management (2024); VMDR — Qualys (2024); Insider Threat Detection — Teramind (2024); Chronicle SIEM Fundamentals (2024)

Security Frameworks: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2

AI — Technical: Python automation, Google Gemini API integration, prompt engineering, local LLM tools (Ollama)

AI — GRC: AI-assisted risk assessment, LLM-assisted policy drafting, AI governance advisory for SMBs

CORE COMPETENCIES

GRC & Compliance: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2, Control Mapping, Audit Support, SOP Development

AI Security & Governance: AI Risk Assessment, Gemini API Integration, Prompt Engineering, LLM-assisted Policy Generation

Security Automation: Python, Flask, CLI Tools, API Integration, JSON/CSV Pipelines, Git, GitLab

Security Operations: SOC Analysis, Detection Tuning, Incident Response, Log Analysis, Threat Hunting

Vulnerability Management: Tenable.io, Nessus, PDQ Deploy, CVE Prioritization, Patch Automation, SLA Compliance

SIEM & Tooling: Splunk, Sentinel, Chronicle, Defender, CrowdStrike, Proofpoint, Jira

EXPERIENCE

Project Manager

Legato Security | Sep 2025 – Present | Remote

- Directed security service delivery for a portfolio of 10+ enterprise clients at an MSSP, coordinating across SOC analysts, engineers, and channel partners to keep projects on track and services delivered on time.
- Developed standardized onboarding workflows and milestone tracking in GuideCX, improving project visibility and reducing the time it takes new clients to get up and running.
- Write QBRs and delivery updates that translate technical security work into plain language for client leadership.
- Designed the connector setup workflow for Mave, giving engineers a documented, repeatable process to follow when configuring client integrations.

Cybersecurity Consultant

Legato Security | Apr 2025 – Jul 2025 | Remote

- Managed vulnerability and patch remediation for 279+ endpoints across regulated aerospace and industrial client environments, prioritizing based on risk level and business impact.
- Redesigned remediation workflows and automated patch deployment, cutting critical vulnerability remediation from several weeks to under 72 hours. That's more than 80% faster.
- Built a Patching-as-a-Service delivery framework that standardized remediation across client environments and reduced manual coordination effort.
- Developed audit-ready SOPs, risk classifications, and remediation documentation that improved governance consistency and accelerated audit preparation for regulated clients.

State IT Security Specialist

Arkansas Department of Public Safety | Oct 2024 – Mar 2025 | Little Rock, AR

- Maintained patch compliance above 95% across 500+ endpoints through automated deployment and consistent remediation tracking, improving audit readiness and reducing exposure to known vulnerabilities.
- Handled IAM for the department, covering provisioning, deprovisioning, MFA resets, and access reviews in Active Directory and Azure AD to enforce least-privilege access.
- Mapped controls to NIST 800-53, collected audit evidence, and prepared compliance documentation that directly supported state regulatory audit responses.

SOC Analyst

Bank OZK | Oct 2021 – Jun 2024 | Little Rock, AR

- Investigated and resolved 30+ phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents per week in a financial-sector SOC, completing phishing investigations in under 20 minutes while maintaining response SLAs and documenting findings for audit.
- Reduced phishing false-positive alerts by 40% through detection rule tuning across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco Secure Email Gateway (SEG), giving the team cleaner signal and less time chasing noise.
- Developed DLP incident response procedures that standardized investigations, reduced analyst decision-making time, and improved audit traceability.

System Operations Analyst I

FIS Global | Jun 2017 – Oct 2021 | Little Rock, AR

- Monitored enterprise systems around the clock using Splunk, responded to service disruptions in real time, and supported root cause investigations.
- Maintained operational playbooks and documentation to support audit compliance and SLA consistency.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

OracleRecon Shield | [oracle-recon-insight.lovable.app](https://github.com/oracle-recon-insight/lovable.app) | Jun 2026

Designed and launched an AI-powered risk assessment platform that automates security evaluations for SMBs without requiring an external consultant. Business owners answer 25 questions across 6 security domains and receive an AI-generated report with a risk grade, prioritized vulnerabilities, and a remediation plan with cost estimates, cutting assessment time from several days to under 30 minutes. Built on Google Gemini 2.5 Flash, subscription billing through Lemon Squeezy (\$49/month), concept to live in under 8 hours, solo.

GRC Engineering Portfolio | gitlab.com/doneal78-group | Jun 2026 – Present

A Python and Flask toolset built to automate the manual work that consumes most of a GRC practitioner's time. The CLI control mapper cross-references NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, and SOC 2 requirements in seconds, reducing manual mapping effort from hours to minutes. The risk register calculates likelihood-impact scores automatically so risk ratings stay consistent across assessors. The compliance evidence collector automates audit artifact gathering from APIs and file systems, organized by control.

OracleRecon | *Independent Security Consulting* | 2025 – Present

Independent GRC and AI security advisory for SMB clients who need security guidance without a full-time security team. Also where The Access Blueprint came from: a structured framework for IAM governance decisions that helps security teams handle access provisioning consistently, available on Gumroad.

Cybersecurity Home Lab | *TCM Security PSAA Capstone* | Jan 2025 – Present

VirtualBox lab with Windows and Ubuntu workstations standing in for a small enterprise network. Where I work through the TCM Security PSAA curriculum and get hands-on time with IR, log analysis, and detection engineering outside of work.

EDUCATION

MARYVILLE UNIVERSITY OF SAINT LOUIS, Online/Remote

M.S., Cybersecurity, 2021

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS GRANTHAM, Online/Remote

B.S., Information Technology, 2019